Is That A Challenge?

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Is That A Challenge?

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Summary

It's late at night and work is far from done.
The workaholics of the office, senior employee Shadow Weaver and the relatively new Castaspella, will end up taking work home. Together, that is…

What can possibly happen?

Notes

Last night I got an idea and couldn't sleep until I wrote it hehe

It's short, but I hope you enjoy!

See the end of the work for more notes

Shadow Weaver's Place

After a long day at work, there's still a ton of paperwork to be processed, and the two workaholics of the office will be the ones taking the responsibility to finish it. However, this night they can’t stay there until late as they would like to.

—Sorry, but tonight security will be testing the alarms. No one can stay— the concierge told Shadow Weaver.

—Do you have any idea of how much paperwork we’re left with!?

—I have orders…

—You can’t tell me…

—Leave it— Castaspella interrupted her, placing a hand on her shoulder. —We’ll have to take this stuff with us to finish at home.

—*You* insisted on sharing the work, and we can’t exactly take half-and-half because it’s all a mess!— the woman pointed out, still quite angry.

—Then we’ll… I-I don’t know… Do-do you mind if I go to your place and we finish this?

—Last time we went to my place to work, we got nothing done because you were complaining about literally everything— she reproached her, folding her arms.

—No, we got nothing done because my brother called me, learnt I was there, and went to pick me up… I only complained *once* about the lighting because I couldn’t see!

—Alright, you know what?— Shadow Weaver began, with a huff. —We’ll go to my place, you’ll have a whole lamp just for yourself, and that phone of yours stays silent— she decided.

—Works for me.

Surprisingly, their plan went without a hitch this time, and in just a few hours, they had finished with all their paperwork, having worked together like a well-oiled clock.

Even they were impressed.

But they were also tired and couldn’t help flopping down on the L-shaped couch for a while, with the television on and a cup of wine. As Shadow Weaver lay on one side, wholly occupying it, Castaspella decided to lay on the other side; the first rested her head on a cushion while the other unapologetically rested on the woman’s chest.

—Seriously?

—Yes…

—As long as you don’t move much…

—I won’t— Castaspella promised, closing her eyes to rest for a moment.

And yet, that “moment” lasted about an hour as she accidentally fell asleep.

She woke up with a gasp, slightly leant forward, and moved her head to the side, barely missing Shadow Weaver’s face.

The woman chuckled sardonically, amused by her startled expression, and for a moment just observed her as she rested back on her chest once more.

It was a good chance to tease her…

—Careful. A bit more to your left and you would have kissed me…— Shadow Weaver said, smirking.

—What if I did?

Castaspella’s teasing tone and look made the woman’s heart skip a beat. It was a sudden change she certainly wasn’t expecting.

—You wouldn't dare…

—Is that a challenge?— she asked, lowering her tone and brushing her lips.

—You’d never…

Castaspella hummed and brushed her lips again, letting out a wide grin at Shadow Weaver’s shock. Slowly, tentatively, she pressed forward and carefully kissed her once, eyes closed. Barely opening them again, she pulled back, just in case the woman had anything to say, but didn’t hesitate to kiss her again as there was no spoken reply.

Being kissed back was enough of an answer.

The women tenderly kissed for a few minutes; with their eyes closed they shared lazy kisses, a few caresses, and relieved sighs.

When they finally pulled apart, Castaspella giggled breathlessly.

—What did I win?

—A rare opportunity to spend the night here…

—Hmm, I’ll take it— she smiled. —Besides, I’m so comfortable here… I don’t want to leave either way…

—I would have let you stay regardless, but on the sofa.

—So what have I *really* won?— Castaspella insisted, pushing herself up to look directly into her eyes, defiant.

—The right to share my bed… if you want it.

She let out another smile, satisfied, and leant forward as she uttered —Sounds perfect.

—Good— Shadow Weaver sighed, before accepting another kiss. —Want some dinner first?

—Absolutely.

About an hour later, the women walked into the bedroom, which Castaspella observed in complete awe. It was an elegant chamber, with satin curtains, dark oak closets, a large mirror at the left of the bed that had a garnet velvet counterpane, and a precious Turkish carpet covering the whole floor.

—Impressed?— Shadow Weaver asked, standing behind Castaspella.

—Quite…

—As you should— she subtly laughed. —Now…— the woman began, placing both hands on her shoulders. —…May I take this off?

—You may— Castaspella accepted, turning around. —If you allow me to do the same…

Shadow Weaver smirked as she unbuttoned the light-blue blouse and nodded absentmindedly. They both stepped closer to the bed, the blouse fell to the floor, and then the woman let Castaspella return the favour.

However, she first pushed her down on the mattress, then leant over her to unbutton her burgundy blouse, and stared at her chest, slowly caressing down her scars.

—What?

—This is…

—Ugly.

—Marvelous…

—How so?

—These all converge around your heart— Castaspella noticed.

—I am alive because they didn’t reach it— Shadow Weaver pointed out.

—You were such a fool…

—Yes, yes. I am aware— the woman replied, rolling her eyes and looking away. —I don't see why you keep bringing it up.

—Sorry— she apologized, smiling gently. —But it's the first time I see the real impact it had on you— she explained, before leaning down to kiss her under the collarbone, following one of the largest scars. —I think… they are beautiful… A proof of… of what you've been through— she commented, between kisses.

—I'd tell you to fuck off if I weren't enjoying this so much…— Shadow Weaver admitted, making Castaspella giggle.

—Good to know.

After a long night together, the women woke up when their alarms went off in their cellphones, and little by little got up.

Without even asking, Castaspella opened one of the closets, luckily finding the racks of blouses and coats, and began rummaging. Meanwhile, Shadow Weaver observed her from the bed with half a smile, as she could hardly believe any of it.

In a single night, her kind-of-friendly relationship with her colleague had changed far too much.

—So, tell me…— she began, keeping her tone calm, trying to hide her suddenly racing heart. —How will things be now? Is this an… isolated event? Or would you like it to be more formal?

Castaspella froze for a second, mid-way through putting on one of Shadow Weaver's blouses, and finished with one move before turning around to look at her.

—Are you asking me to be your partner?— she questioned her, once again looking defiantly at her.

—If it means I get to see you half naked wearing my clothes more often, sure…— the woman replied, smirking.

Without buttoning the blouse, Castaspella returned to the bed and crawled over the mattress until she reached Shadow Weaver's side. With a soft smile, she wrapped her arms around the woman and kissed her cheek for a moment.

—Then official it is…

That day, they arrived together at work, each with their cup of coffee, and it was more than evident that the magenta blouse Castaspella was wearing was *not* hers, so they quickly became the talk of the office.

They were fully aware, but couldn't care less; every time someone gave them a curious look, whenever they caught their colleagues whispering about them, they laughed to themselves or shared a look like an inside joke.

—Is it me or do we have twice as much paperwork today?— Castaspella noticed that night.

—It's you… There's actually *trice* more— Shadow Weaver replied, laughing at the end. — It's too much to take home…

—But it will accumulate with tomorrow's paperwork if we leave it.

—You wouldn't happen to be suggesting we work at your place tonight?— the woman dared her.

—Is that a challenge?

—Seeing how the last one went, it sure is— she replied, smirking.

Castaspella's Place

Chapter Notes

Okay.
Two people in less than 12hrs asked for a continuation, so here it is. A second part.

But, I got a bit excited and… this is 4 times longer than the first chapter <("^_^)

Anyways, I hope you enjoy, and with any luck, all my investigation of traditional Japanese homes was enough to properly describe Casta's home. If any of you know about this stuff and find something odd, please point it out, thank you very much <3

Now yes, please enjoy!!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The evening was quite cold as the women arrived at Castaspella's home. Shadow Weaver walked into the narrow entryway, carrying all the paperwork, and aimed to step on the elevated wooden floor to enter the house, but was suddenly stopped and almost tripped over.

—Sorry, sorry. Just… Let me help you— Castaspella apologized, taking the paperwork from her hands. —Can you take off your shoes now? I'll take this to the dining room, and we can work there…— she said, trying and failing to hide her nervousness.

—I should have guessed this was more of a traditional house when I saw the façade…

—I should have told you before…— she insisted as she returned. —There are slippers to your left if you want… Or you can walk around in socks, I guess— she laughed.

—Slippers it is— Shadow Weaver uttered, sliding her feet into a pair. —Alright. Time to work so we finish before midnight.

—Agreed. But if we work as well as yesterday, we should be done in time for dinner— Castaspella pointed out.

—We do work pretty well, don't we?— she concurred, smirking. —But for that, I'll need a good cup of wine…

—I should say "no drinking while working", but actually the problem is we don't have wine in this house. Only sake.

—What!?

—Sorry— Castaspella replied, unapologetic.

—You know what, I'll have what I can— Shadow Weaver accepted, pressing her hands to her forehead. —Now, where did you leave the paperwork?

—Come with me— she invited her, heading into the room to their left.

The woman followed her, far too self-centered to notice her surroundings, until she saw where the paperwork was.

—Why is the table so short? And where are the chairs?

—*That* is a chabudai, alright? And there are no chairs because you're supposed to sit down on these cushions— Castaspella explained, making a show of sitting down. —But…— she then said, pushing herself up. —I'll first bring the sake, you sit down.

—A-alright…

This was certainly a new experience for Shadow Weaver. Far too new. But it wasn't exactly bad, either. It was just *different*.

Now, could she handle so much difference?

—Here it is— Castaspella said, returning with a beautifully decorated ceramic bottle in one hand, and a pair of ceramic cups in the other. —In case you want to know, this bottle is called tokkuri, and these cups are called choko. This is how you traditionally drink sake— she explained, pouring her a cup.

—It's… so small…

—I assure you, it may be smaller, but it's about the same amount typically served in a glass of wine.

—Alright, I'll trust you. Now let's work.

—First, try it. I want to know your opinion— Castaspella giggled.

—I- Fine— Shadow Weaver agreed, rolling her eyes. She let out an amused smile as she shook her head and brought the choko to her lips. —This smells strong— she noticed, opening her eyes in surprise.

—It is… yes.

—This better be good…

—It's the best one I have— she assured her, which made the woman smirk before finally tasting the sake.

—Alright, it wasn't terrible…

—Aw, what!?

—I still prefer wine, but I can survive a night with sake— she clarified, teasing.

—That's enough for me— Castaspella accepted, finally sitting in front of Shadow Weaver. —Let's get to work, then.

As expected, they were able to finish in just a few hours. Surprisingly enough, it was easier to work like that than in the office because there were no distractions. Sitting across from each other, they could share information and papers more efficiently instead of having to walk through the whole office.

—Alright. I think we finished in record time— Shadow Weaver noticed, looking at her cellphone.

—Did we?— Castaspella asked, surprised. —Well, *finally*! It was so much!

—Indeed…— the woman agreed, drinking the remaining sake in her cup. —Now, you better have a television in this house, or I swear…

—I have one in my room, don't worry…

—Good— she sighed, albeit smirking right after as she gave Castaspella a teasing look. —Where should I go then?

—I suggest you first visit the bathroom and freshen up…— she mocked her, standing up and collecting the choko and the tokkuri.

—Are you trying to tell me I'm filthy?— Shadow Weaver questioned her, standing up too.

—No, no. I just think… well… we *both* should freshen up— she replied from the kitchen. —Remember where the entrance was? Go to your right this time— she indicated, returning to the dining room. —Or just follow me— she then offered, leaving the room while looking back at the woman with an amused look.

—Alright, alright— she sighed. —Lead the way…

This time, opposite to earlier, she couldn't help looking around as she followed her, taking in the strange yet beautiful architecture.

—Here— Castaspella finally said, opening the door for her. —I'll go to my room for a moment, and be right back.

It caught the woman's attention for a second that this was probably the only area of the house that actually had a door like the entrance. And when she walked into the bathroom, saying Shadow Weaver was impressed would be an understatement.

Like the rest of the house, it looked very traditional but, if her memory still served her, this place was more like a public bathing house, or even a spa; not the kind of bathroom you'd find in a particular house.

—How is your bathroom bigger than your kitchen? What do you even need such a big bathroom for!?

—This place was my parents', remember? It's honestly akin to a mansion, I won't lie… But the bathroom was my father's pride and joy— Castaspella replied from her room.

—I can see that…— she uttered. The woman stepped inside warily. There was an initial room with everything you'd find in an occidental bathroom, a sink and a toilet, a separate space with a shower… —Is there a stool under the shower?

—Yes. To sit down while you clean yourself up!— she explained, appearing at the door. —Which you should do before going into the next room, here…— she added, walking past her and into the following section of the bathroom.

—I prefer bathtubs— Shadow Weaver clarified, rolling her eyes as she followed her. —I suppose something like that, yes.

—That bathtub is for *after* you shower— Castaspella clarified, realizing she had noticed the wooden tub.

—I don't understand.

—As you can see, it's big enough to fit several people— she began. —That's because it *is* supposed to fit several people! The bathtub is to soak in hot water, not wash yourself. So you have to shower first, get rid of all the sweat and dirt from the day, also the makeup, and then you can come to enjoy a hot bath… My father called this the "Steam Grotto"— Castaspella further explained, giggling at the end.

—You wear makeup?

—My lipstick…

—Which tastes awful, by the way…

—You're not supposed to eat it— Castaspella mocked her.

—Did you dislike the lip bites?

—No…

—Good to know— she smirked. Looking around again, she insisted —So… it *is* like a spa.

—If you want to look at it that way…

—And tell me…— Shadow Weaver began, wrapping an arm around Castaspella's waist. —What do I have to do to convince you to share a bath with me?

—Ask nicely— she smirked. —And follow the simple indications I gave you: first, you shower, then you soak.

—Alright— the woman laughed. —Before or after dinner?

—Before, trust me— Castaspella immediately replied. She then sighed and added —We really deserve some relaxation after all that paperwork, no?

—We absolutely do…

—Then come with me; I'll give you a robe.

After undressing back in the bedroom, the women returned to the bathroom wearing simple night robes.

As promised, Shadow Weaver first took a shower, albeit exaggerating her discomfort. Yet Castaspella completely shocked her, offering to wash her hair instead of scolding her in any way.

She was so gentle and caring, it made the woman regret her little fuss. So much so, she decided to return the favor; while she sat on the stool, Shadow Weaver carefully rinsed her hair, unwillingly enjoying the intimacy of the moment.

Right after, they went into the steamy bathtub Castaspella had prepared before their shower. The women rested back with their eyes closed as they enjoyed the relaxing hot water, and remained quiet for a while.

Eventually, Shadow Weaver broke the silence.

—This is the most relaxed I've been in a long time…

—That's good to hear— Castaspella smiled.

—If I had this bathroom at home, I would hardly leave the house— the woman commented, humming contentedly.

—You're welcome to stay as long as you want… or until the water goes cold— she giggled.

—Aren't you afraid I might overstay my welcome?

—Not really…

—I don't believe you. You wouldn't dare give me such a free pass…

—Is that a challenge?— Castaspella asked, looking back at the woman with a brow raised.

—You seem to love challenges lately— she pointed out.

Pushing herself away from her side of the bathtub and moving closer to Shadow Weaver, she replied —I particularly like *your* challenges…

—Is that so? Then what should I dare you to do next, I wonder— the woman joked.

—Careful what you wish for— Castaspella warned her, sitting on her lap and leaning forward to kiss her.

—Up to now, I'm more than satisfied with everything I've gotten.

—Glad to hear that— she sighed, before planting another kiss on her lips. —I was worried you might have some doubts now…

—It's all been really fast, yes, but the more I learn about you, the more I like you.

Her tone was completely serious; no teasing or mocking, she meant it. And that was exactly why it took Castaspella aback.

—That's…

—Yes, I mean it.

—I'm glad— she finally managed to let out, blushing as she looked away. —I've been so nervous all evening…

—You can relax— Shadow Weaver assured her, wrapping her arms around Castaspella's waist to pull her closer. —Forget your insecurities, will you?

—Perhaps you can help me with that…

—Gladly— she smirked, and kissed her again.

About an hour later, they were lying together in bed, watching television. At their feet, there was a small tray with a pair of empty dishes they had used for dinner, and a pair of choko, empty too.

—Tired already?— Castaspella asked, tracing invisible patterns down Shadow Weaver's chest.

—Are you?

—Yes, although not sleepy.

—Then what about we turn off the television and enjoy each other a bit?— the woman proposed.

—That sounds good— she smiled.

And so, as Castaspella took the tray back to the kitchen, Shadow Weaver turned off the television and took off her robes while waiting for her to return.

Like the previous night, they explored each other, tested their limits, little by little learning what the other likes and dislikes, and spent a long intimate night together.

It was a beautiful weekend morning.

The women woke up in each other's arms and refused to get up.

However, the doorbell rang right that moment… *several times*.

—Who the heck comes here so early in the morning?— Shadow Weaver groggily asked.

—I can only think of one person… Better put something on— Castaspella told her, reluctantly pulling away from her embrace and getting up. However, instead of going to see who it was, she decided to check her phone to corroborate her suspicions. And yes, she was right; but it was even worse. —Oh, damn it! It's my brother *and* his wife. Get dressed— she ordered.

—And here I thought I could laze around in these robes today…— Shadow Weaver lamented. —Curious that you let them come unannounced for breakfast.

—I don't. I've told them plenty of times to tell me in advance, but they never do— Castaspella grunted. —At least I got Micah to give up his key to the house… Otherwise, this would have been *worse*.

—You have to be kidding me.

—No, I swear. Until last month, he'd simply come in unannounced and scared the living heck out of me.

—Glad to know you have some *actual* privacy now— Shadow Weaver laughed.

—As much as I can get, indeed.

Castaspella finally got up, now dressed, and left the room, leaving the woman to finish putting on her clothes.

However, from the room, she could perfectly hear the loud discussion at the entrance.

—When will you learn to inform me before showing up at my doorstep!?

—Come on, Sis. You wouldn't keep your own brother out, would you?

—Right now, I am very tempted, Micah— she admitted, her tone obviously annoyed. —Believe it or not, I'm not alone.

—You-you have company!?— he stammered.

—That's normally what "not alone" means, Brother— Castaspella retorted.

—Someone is grumpy this morning— Angella joked, clearly uncomfortable.

—You know what!? Come in before I change my mind— she finally agreed.

—Sha-Shadow Weaver!?— Micah exclaimed, as soon as he saw the woman walk out of the bedroom, fortunately decent, much to Castaspella's relief.

—Is that a problem?— his sister asked him, folding her arms and stepping between them both.

—Since when is this happening!?— he indignantly asked.

—Since yesterday.

—Are you seriously having an affair with *her*!?

—She's my *partner*, Micah. We're in a formal relationship…

—Partner!?

—Yes.

—Bu-but, just like that!?

—Yes.

—With *her*!?

—Yes.

—O-overnight!?

—Yes, quite literally.

—I-I don't understand!

—And you don't have to, Brother.

—No, no, no, no. I am not- I can't just…

—Careful what you're about to say— Castaspella warned him. —If you can't *accept it*, that's your problem. But if you think you can decide whether you *allow* it or not, then save your breath and leave my house.

—*Our* house— he reminded her.

—Not since you moved out and *left me* the house, Brother…

—Alright, enough, you two. Discussions about the house never end well— Angella interrupted.

—This is about that woman!— Micah exclaimed, pointing at Shadow Weaver. —And *of course* it won't end well!

—I'm flattered, Micah, but you could simply express your contempt for me through the phone…— she mocked him.

—You think I came here for you!? Get off your high horse, would you!? Oh, I know, better yet: Get out of here!— he yelled, while being held back by his wife.

—Um… no.

Shadow Weaver gave him a wicked smirk and placed a hand on Castaspella's shoulder, as if reaffirming her reply.

—And you will just *let her*!?— Micah then asked his sister, expression defeated, no longer trying to escape Angella's grasp.

—Of course I will!— she quickly replied, between confused and indignant. —Like it or not, she's my *partner* now; I invited her, so she's staying.

—Alright!— Angella interrupted again, extending the word. —Why don't we sit and have breakfast now? I'm sure we're all hungry…

—Maybe if you didn't come unannounced so early in the morning…— Castaspella hissed, between her teeth, heading for the kitchen. —I'll prepare some tea; you three, survive until I'm done.

—Casta!— all three complained in unison, but could only watch her walk out of the room.

Eventually, Micah calmed down and sat on a cushion in front of the chabudai, arms folded as he angrily stared at Shadow Weaver, who had sat opposite to him. By his side, Angella tried to call his attention but he would only grunt in reply.

—Here's the tea!— Castaspella finally announced as she returned with a tray between her hands. —There's not much to eat, but I think there are some left-over pastries from yesterday.

—That would be perfect, I'm sure— Angella replied, notoriously nervous.

—Be right back, then.

Silence settled as Micah glared at Shadow Weaver while the woman stared back, defiant.

—Come on, you two. Let's have a civilized discussion, like the adults we are— Angella begged.

—Not with *her*!— he complained. Right after, he addressed the woman, inquiring —What do you think you're doing with my sister!?

—Having fun. Enjoying myself. Working all evening… Should I go on? Do you want details?— she replied, sardonic.

—My sister is not your toy!

—Who said anything about…— she began, suddenly angry, but interrupted herself as Castaspella returned with the pastries.

—Please, I want to hear that— she said, sitting next to Shadow Weaver. She leant onto the woman, placing a hand on her shoulder, and briefly kissed her cheek before insisting —What were you going to say?

—Sis!— Micah exclaimed, disgruntled.

—Let me make this clear— Shadow Weaver began. Looking straight at Micah, she sentenced —Your sister isn't a plaything for me. This was sudden, yes, but I'm not stupid. I recognize potential when I see it, and I want to see where this leads.

—You're really invested, aren't you?— Castaspella whispered.

—Did you doubt it?

—I feared you weren't, actually— she admitted, looking down.

—Remember what I said last night— Shadow Weaver told her, grabbing her by the chin to tilt her head up so she looked into her eyes. —Forget your insecurities. The more I learn about you, the more I like you.

—Aww!— Angella let out, moved. —That's so sweet!

—Sweet!? It's insane!

—Micah!

—No, no, for real! What even happened in the past two days!?

The women in front of him rolled their eyes simultaneously and grabbed their cups of tea. Castaspella shook her head and took a long sip, while Shadow Weaver let out a short laugh, took a sip, and put it down again before speaking.

—Paperwork happened.

—What!?

—Long story short, I dared your sister to kiss me, and she did, boldly enough… I don't know why, but trust me, Micah, I'm glad she did. I am serious.

—Sis, why would you do that!? Just because she challenged you?— he asked, indignant.

Castaspella finally put her cup down and shook her head again, more notoriously this time.

—I… To-to be honest…— she began, looking away, completely flustered. —I may have… had a little crush on her since I met her at work— she admitted, unable to look back at

Shadow Weaver. —I've been… *dreaming* about kissing her for so long that, when I had the chance, I took it— she explained, glancing back at him. —I don't expect you to understand, but I would appreciate it if you didn't shame me for it…

—No one is shaming you, don't think that— Angella assured her, giving Micah a warning look.

—A crush, huh?— the woman whispered, leaning closer to Castaspella and resting a hand on top of hers on the cushion. —When were you planning to tell me?

—Never— she scoffed. —I was so sure you'd laugh at me…

—I find it amusing, but also flattering— Shadow Weaver replied.

—How can you be so… so *reckless*, Sis!?— Micah finally expressed. —Out of all people, why her!?

—What do you mean by that?— the woman inquired, squinting at him and unconsciously gripping Castaspella's hand.

—You're a *bad* influence. Next thing we know, my sister will be all covered in scars like you!

While Castaspella remained silent, looking down with a gloomy expression, Shadow Weaver didn't hesitate to reply —Do you realize you're both insulting your sister's intelligence *and* her judgement? I don't care whether you think I'm a monster, but for someone who claims to love his sister and worries so much, you sure don't respect her enough.

—What do you mean!? I…

—Enough!— Castaspella interrupted at last, completely fed up. When she looked up, her eyes were full of tears. —Can't you see me happy, Micah? Can't you trust me? Look, I *know* she's a proud egocentric bitch, but that also makes her assertive and unafraid of going for what she wants. And she may not care for other's feelings or needs, that's true, but she's really attentive. She just chooses not to prioritize others' needs but rather hers; I'm the exact opposite, which is just as bad! She's smart, cunning, ambitious… She's not perfect, but neither am I! And there's a lot I could learn from her. There's a lot I *like* about her.

—This is a mistake, Sis. I don't want to see you hurt…

—But you should let me make mistakes! If I get hurt, that's on me! Let me learn on my own!

Her tears finally fell, wetting her face, and she couldn't help looking down and immediately stuffing her mouth with a pastry. As she tried to swallow through the lump in her throat, Shadow Weaver carefully brushed away her tears.

—I won't make you any promises, Micah. But I can swear, I'm not toying with your sister— the woman told him, her eyes still on Castaspella. —I wouldn't dare do that to her.

—Why? Why should I believe you'd have such considerations for her?— he calmly asked, already feeling guilty for making his sister cry.

—She's your family. I would never purposely hurt you or your family again— she admitted, barely glancing back at him. —I owe you that much.

—Owe me…— he repeated, grabbing his cup of tea. He took a long sip, considering her words, and then asked her —What will happen the day you lose interest in this relationship?

—*If* the day ever comes that I am dissatisfied with my relationship with your sister, I will simply be honest about it. We'll resolve it like the adults we are, Micah. Your sister isn't a kid.

—I… know.

—You need to trust her more— Angella gently told him. —You can have your doubts about Shadow Weaver, but that is *you*.

—Your sister is *not* an extension of yourself— the woman pointed out, returning her attention to Castaspella. She carefully brushed her chin with a finger, tenderly encouraging her to raise her head, and added —It may be difficult for you to accept, but she's her own woman… and, as she isn't just a female you, I plan on getting to know her in depth.

Micah stared at his tea.

His reflection looked back at him and made him realize he was really treating Castaspella as some younger female version of himself. As if she were some mirror copy instead of her own person.

After a moment, he gulped and said —Sorry, Sis. I-I… will call you before coming to visit. A-and I won't… Ugh… I won't interfere in your relationship with her…

—Thank you— she replied, barely holding back a sob.

—Perhaps we should… leave— he uttered, putting down his cup.

—N-no, no. I- It's alright, you can stay— Castaspella rushed to clarify. She then glanced at Shadow Weaver and asked her —Do you mind?

—Not at all…

—Are you sure? We don't want to bother you further— Angella told her.

—I insist. You can stay. I… think we have a lot to discuss— she commented, letting out a subtle laugh.

Smirking, Shadow Weaver moved closer to her ear and whispered —I bet you can't put them up to date in less than an hour… And yes, that's a challenge.

Chapter End Notes

I have mixed feelings about posting this, I feel like I went overboard, ngl...

But I also really enjoyed crafting the idea of Casta living in a traditional Japanese mansion, loved investigating all the details and terminology, and yes, I just *had* to make the steam grotto joke.
Admit it, you liked it :3

Anyways, I hope you enjoyed this chapter too!!

End Notes

So? What do you think?

I know I usually write slowburns, not *this*, but this idea was eating my brain, I had to share it lol

Anyways, I hope you enjoyed it and see you in another fic!

Edit: What do you think of the second part? It wasn't planned at all, but I couldn't refuse the request for a continuation XP
So, was it too much? Did it ruin the fic? Should it have stayed a one-shot?

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!